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Ukrainians moving toward the front line Sunday near Bakhmut. Hundreds of troops joined the counteroffensive over the weekend.

## Nearly Encircled, Ukrainian Troops Push Back

By CARLOTTA GALL

CHASIV YAR, Ukraine — Lined up in the dark in civilian vehicles, lights dimmed, a company of soldiers waited silently at the side of a road. Farther behind, a second company was parked, an occasional light inside a car revealing the face of a soldier. Still farther back, a third company was moving into place.

After months of pitched battle, the fight over the Ukrainian city of Bakhmut had seemed in recent days to be reaching a climax, with Russian forces close to encircling the city and some Ukrainian units pulling out.

Then, early Saturday, Ukrainian assault brigades went on the attack. Over the weekend, hundreds of troops joined the counteroffensive, mounting assaults from the ground and pounding Russian positions with artillery from the surrounding hills.

### Bakhmut Battle Is Test of Which Army Can Break the Other

Ukrainian commanders acknowledged that their forces in Bakhmut still faced the risk of encirclement, but the fighting over the weekend showed that a military that has surprised the world with its doggedness was not yet ready to give up on Bakhmut. How holding the city might fit in with its broader plans was less clear.

Even before Ukraine stepped up its attack on Russians in Bakhmut on the weekend, its forces had moved to beat Russian troops back from the last main highway into the city. That preserved both a supply line that has helped Ukrainian soldiers tie down the Russian offensive for

months and an exit route for them should they decide to retreat.

“I’m confident Bakhmut will hold,” said Col. Yevhen Mezhevikin, commander of a combined tactical group fighting in Bakhmut. “We have enough forces to throw the enemy back from this city, but it depends on the tasks the command has, be it holding the city, or inflicting maximum losses on the enemy.”

Other soldiers on the field seem far less confident.

Bakhmut itself, a city with a pre-war population of 70,000 inhabitants, has little strategic value. It was simply the next in the line of fire of a Russian offensive to seize the eastern province of Donetsk. But the battle for the city has cre-

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**THE FARTHEST EDGE** In the trenches where Russian soldiers are close enough to see. **PAGE A6**

## With Caution, South Korea Arms Globe

By CHOE SANG-HUN

CHANGWON, South Korea — A year after Russia invaded Ukraine, the war has spurred a global effort to produce more missiles, tanks, artillery shells and other munitions. And few countries have moved as quickly as South Korea to increase output.

Last year, South Korea’s arms exports rose 140 percent to a record \$17.3 billion, including deals worth \$12.4 billion to sell tanks, howitzers, fighter jets and multiple rocket launchers to Poland, one of Ukraine’s closest allies.

But as South Korea expands weapons sales globally, it has refused to send lethal assistance to Ukraine itself. Instead, it has focused on filling the world’s rearmament gap while resisting any direct role in arming Ukraine, imposing strict export control rules on all its sales.

South Korea’s wariness stems in part from its reluctance to openly antagonize Moscow, from which it hopes for cooperation in imposing new sanctions against

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## Deploying A.I. To Find Cancer Doctors Miss Technology Shows Skill at Mammograms

By ADAM SATARIANO and CADE METZ

KECSKEMÉT, Hungary — Inside a dark room at Bács-Kiskun County Hospital outside Budapest, Dr. Éva Ambrózay, a radiologist with more than two decades of experience, peered at a computer monitor showing a patient’s mammogram.

Two radiologists had previously said the X-ray did not show any signs that the patient had breast cancer. But Dr. Ambrózay was looking closely at several areas of the scan circled in red, which artificial intelligence software had flagged as potentially cancerous.

“This is something,” she said. She soon ordered the woman to be called back for a biopsy, which is taking place within the next week.

Advancements in A.I. are beginning to deliver breakthroughs in breast cancer screening by detecting the signs that doctors miss. So far, the technology is showing an impressive ability to spot cancer at least as well as human radiologists, according to early results and radiologists, in what is one of the most tangible signs to date of how A.I. can improve public health.

Hungary, which has a robust breast cancer screening program, is one of the largest testing grounds for the technology on real patients. At five hospitals and clinics that perform more than 35,000 screenings a year, A.I. systems were rolled out starting in 2021 and now help to check for signs of cancer that a radiologist may have overlooked. Clinics and hospitals in the United States, Britain and the European Union are also beginning to test or provide data to help develop the systems.

A.I. usage is growing as the technology has become the center of a Silicon Valley boom, with the release of chatbots like ChatGPT showing how A.I. has a remarkable ability to communicate in humanlike prose — sometimes with worrying results. Built off a similar form used by chatbots that is modeled on the human brain, the breast cancer screening technology shows other ways that A.I. is seeping into everyday life.

Widespread use of the cancer detection technology still faces many hurdles, doctors and A.I. developers said. Additional clinical trials are needed before the systems can be more widely adopted as an automated second or third reader of breast cancer screens, beyond the limited number of places now using the technology. The tool must also show it can produce accurate results on women of all ages, ethnicities and body types. And the technology must

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## ALLIES IN FLORIDA ARE SET TO ENACT DESANTIS AGENDA

### WISH LIST OF THE RIGHT

### G.O.P. Lawmakers Help Raise the Governor’s National Profile

By PATRICIA MAZZEI

MIAMI — Gov. Ron DeSantis of Florida has made it his political mission to, as he likes to say, put points on the board.

He is about to run up the score.

Since his landslide re-election victory, the emboldened Republican governor has proposed or endorsed policy after policy that has enthralled his supporters and alarmed his detractors: Allow Floridians to carry concealed weapons without a permit or training. Ban diversity and equity programs at public universities. Expand school vouchers. Allow a death sentence without a unanimous jury. Make it easier to sue the news media. Further restrict abortion.

Most — and perhaps all — of Mr. DeSantis’s wishes will likely soon be granted by the Republican-held State Legislature, giving him a broader platform from which to launch a widely expected 2024 presidential campaign. Ahead of the annual session, scheduled to begin on Tuesday and last 60 days, Republican lawmakers have given every indication that they will be guided by whatever the governor wants.

“We’re going to get his agenda across the finish line,” Kathleen Passidomo, the Republican Senate president, said last month.

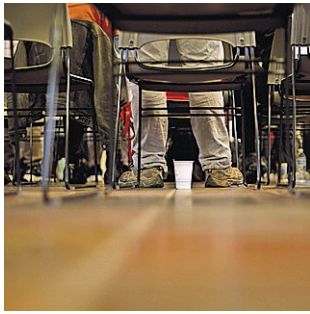
Mr. DeSantis has not been shy about using his power; last year he redrew congressional districts to give Republicans an even bigger advantage in the state. And his approach of picking high-profile fights has turned Florida into a frenzied culture-war battleground, where even political insiders struggle to keep up with the dizzying array of sweeping policy developments.

Mr. DeSantis already called lawmakers into a special session in February to address problems with laws they had previously passed at his behest — chiefly a 2022 budget provision that allowed him to spend \$12 million to transport unauthorized migrants out of Florida. Instead, the DeSantis administration flew 48 Venezuelan migrants from San Antonio to Martha’s Vineyard last September, prompting a lawsuit.

During the special session, lawmakers repealed that language, allowing the DeSantis administration to transport migrants from anywhere in the United States.

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### HEADWAY



PHOTOGRAPHS BY ABDUL KIRCHER FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

## What Don’t You Know About Homelessness?

Above, the daily sights of Matthew Kearney, who spent a decade living in his van in San Diego. The Times asked him, and dozens of others, to share their experiences. **PAGES A11-14**

## Vital to Humans but Unprotected in Some States

By CATRIN EINHORN

It’s tough being an insect. They get swatted, stomped and sprayed without a thought. Their mere presence can provoke irrational panic. Even everyday language disparages them: “Stop bugging me,” we say.

To make matters worse for insects, they have also been sidelined legally in some states, with unintended but serious repercussions. The reason? According to many state statutes, insects are not considered wildlife.

Bees, butterflies and beetles pollinate plants, enrich soils and provide a critical protein source for species up the food chain. The United States Forest Service puts it simply: “Without pollinators, the human race and all of earth’s terrestrial ecosystems would not survive.”

Ecologically they are “the little



RICK & NORA BOWERS/ALAMY

Insects like the large marble butterfly have had alarming declines.

things that run the world,” in the words of the biologist E.O. Wilson.

But those little things are increasingly threatened. Scientists are reporting alarming declines in many species. Some insects ap-

pear especially vulnerable to climate change’s supercharged droughts and heat, which hit them hard in addition to chronic pressures like disappearing habitat,

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#### NATIONAL A10-20

##### Drag Events in Doubt

A Tennessee law is part of a wave of legislation across the country that could limit drag performances. The question is how it will be applied. **PAGE A17**

##### Voting Rights ‘Under Assault’

Speaking in Selma, Ala., on the 58th anniversary of “Bloody Sunday,” the president said protecting ballot access was essential to civil rights. **PAGE A15**

##### Preparing to Fight in the Pacific

A 10-day exercise gave a Marine regiment the chance to test island-fighting concepts the Pentagon may one day need in a battle with China. **PAGE A10**

#### INTERNATIONAL A4-9

##### Quake Aid May Buoy al-Assad

The U.S. has eased sanctions on Syria’s authoritarian government, angering the regime’s opponents. **PAGE A4**

##### Feeding Souls at a Strip Mall

Some of Toronto’s best dining options are immigrant mom-and-pop shops that recall tastes from home. **PAGE A8**



#### BUSINESS B1-6

##### The Non-Promotion

Employers mislabel rank-and-file workers as managers to avoid paying them overtime, researchers say, and it costs the workers \$4 billion a year. **PAGE B1**

##### Saving by Moving Back Home

As more young adults opt to live with their parents, many say it is necessary to meet their financial goals. **PAGE B1**

#### OBITUARIES D7-8

##### Fighter for Disability Rights

Judy Heumann helped stoke a revolution in the government’s treatment of disabled people. She was 75. **PAGE D7**

#### ARTS C1-6

##### Hard-Hitting Comedy

A year after Will Smith slapped him at the Oscars, Chris Rock responded fiercely in a new stand-up special. **PAGE C1**

##### Going With the Flow

SZA employed an aquatic theme for a New York show with appearances by Cardi B and Phoebe Bridgers. **PAGE C1**



#### SPORTS D1-6

##### Extraordinarily Ordinary

Hansel Enmanuel, who lost his left arm at 6, doesn’t want sympathy. He just wants to play basketball. **PAGE D1**

##### The Signings That Weren’t

The San Francisco Giants, who lost out on Aaron Judge and Carlos Correa, focus on the players they have. **PAGE D5**

#### OPINION A22-23

##### Michael Bloomberg

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